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The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study

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Abstract

Purpose: Understanding the experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) using activity monitors in daily life could support the utilisation of technology within healthcare to increase physical activity and support self-management. This qualitative study aimed to explore the experiences of people with COPD using activity monitors at home in everyday life.

Methods: Semi-structured face-to-face or telephone interviews were conducted with seven people with COPD between August 2018 and June 2020. Participants had all used an activity monitor within the last year (Fitbit, Garmin, or Apple Watch). Interviews were analysed in-depth using Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA).

Results: Four themes, developed using IPA, highlight participants' engagement with activity monitors and integrating them into their lives: 1) Motivational features to monitor activity, 2) Importance of setting achievable goals, 3) Developing knowledge and awareness, and 4) Integration into everyday life for self-management.

Conclusion: Activity monitors were perceived to be beneficial and useful to people with COPD, not just for monitoring their activity, but also helping to self-manage their condition. Activity monitors may be a useful tool within rehabilitation and healthcare services for COPD.

Original language English

Pages (from-to) (In-Press)

Number of pages 11

Journal [Disability and Rehabilitation](#)

Volume (In-Press)

Early online date 18 Jan 2024

DOIs • <https://doi.org/10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095>

Publication status E-pub ahead of print - 18 Jan 2024

Bibliographical note

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Funder

LW's PhD studies (of which this study is a part of) was funded by the Centre for Intelligent Healthcare, Coventry University, UK

Keywords

- activity tracker
- Exercise
- physical activity
- pulmonary rehabilitation
- respiratory care
- respiratory disease
- self-management
- wearable technology

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[Wilde, L., Percy, C., Ward, G., Clark, C., Wark, P., & Sewell, L. \(2024\). The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease \(COPD\) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study. **Disability and Rehabilitation**, \(In-Press\), \(In-Press\). Advance online publication. <https://doi.org/10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095>](#)

[The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease \(COPD\) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study. / Wilde, Laura; Percy, Carol; Ward, Gillian et al.](#)

In: [Disability and Rehabilitation](#), Vol. (In-Press), 18.01.2024, p. (In-Press).

Research output: Contribution to journal > Article > peer-review

[Wilde, L, Percy, C, Ward, G, Clark, C, Wark, P & Sewell, L 2024, 'The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease \(COPD\) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study', **Disability and Rehabilitation**, vol. \(In-Press\), pp. \(In-Press\). <https://doi.org/10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095>](#)

[Wilde L, Percy C, Ward G, Clark C, Wark P, Sewell L. The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease \(COPD\) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study. **Disability and Rehabilitation**. 2024 Jan 18;\(In-Press\):\(In-Press\). Epub 2024 Jan 18. doi: /10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095](#)

[Wilde, Laura ; Percy, Carol ; Ward, Gillian et al. / **The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease \(COPD\) using activity monitors in everyday life : An interpretative phenomenological study**. In: **Disability and Rehabilitation**. 2024 ; Vol. \(In-Press\). pp. \(In-Press\).](#)

@article{7e6245778042481d855c7568fd90797b,

title = "The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) using activity monitors in everyday life: An interpretative phenomenological study",

abstract = "Purpose: Understanding the experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) using activity monitors in daily life could support the utilisation of technology within healthcare to increase physical activity and support self-management. This qualitative study aimed to explore the experiences of people with COPD using activity monitors at home in everyday life. Methods: Semi-structured face-to-face or telephone interviews were conducted with seven people with COPD between August 2018 and June 2020. Participants had all used an activity monitor within the last year (Fitbit, Garmin, or Apple Watch). Interviews were analysed in-depth using Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis (IPA). Results: Four themes, developed using IPA, highlight participants' engagement with activity monitors and integrating them into their lives: 1) Motivational features to monitor activity, 2) Importance of setting achievable goals, 3) Developing knowledge and awareness, and 4) Integration into everyday life for self-management. Conclusion: Activity monitors were perceived to be beneficial and useful to people with COPD, not just for monitoring their activity, but also helping to self-manage their condition. Activity monitors may be a useful tool within rehabilitation and healthcare services for COPD.",

keywords = "activity tracker, Exercise, physical activity, pulmonary rehabilitation, respiratory care, respiratory disease, self-management, wearable technology",
author = "Laura Wilde and Carol Percy and Gillian Ward and Cain Clark and Petra Wark and Louise Sewell",
note = "{\textcopyright} 2024 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group This is an Open Access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (<http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. The terms on which this article has been published allow the posting of the Accepted Manuscript in a repository by the author(s) or with their consent.",
year = "2024",
month = jan,
day = "18",
doi = "/10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095",
language = "English",
volume = "(In-Press)",
pages = "(In--Press)",
journal = "Disability and Rehabilitation",
issn = "0963-8288",
publisher = "Taylor and Francis",
}

TY - JOUR

T1 - The experiences of people with Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD) using activity monitors in everyday life

T2 - An interpretative phenomenological study

AU - Wilde, Laura

AU - Percy, Carol

AU - Ward, Gillian

AU - Clark, Cain

AU - Wark, Petra

AU - Sewell, Louise

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PY - 2024/1/18

Y1 - 2024/1/18

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UR - <http://www.scopus.com/inward/record.url?scp=85182434605&partnerID=8YFLogxK>

U2 - /10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095

DO - /10.1080/09638288.2024.2304095

M3 - Article

SN - 0963-8288

SN - 1464-5165

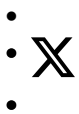
VL - (In-Press)

SP - (In-Press)

JO - Disability and Rehabilitation

JF - Disability and Rehabilitation

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